PRINT COST & PROFIT

COMPLETE GUIDE · ENGLISH

A business tool for 3D printing — not just a calculator

Calculate production costs, estimate selling prices, review profit and margin, organise filament stock, save valuations, prepare quotes and invoices, manage customers and orders, and record business income and expenses.

What the guide covers

• Cost calculation: print time, filament, machine profile and supported cost factors.
• Orca workflow: import available G-code information into the calculator when the integration is configured.
• Printer monitor: track compatible configured prints and register filament consumption when the printer provides sufficient data.
• Filament inventory, saved valuations, quotes, invoices, customers, order status and follow-up.
• Accounting records: business expenses, order-related expenses, manual sales and expenses, and financial results.
• Interface available in six languages: Spanish, English, French, German, Italian and Polish.

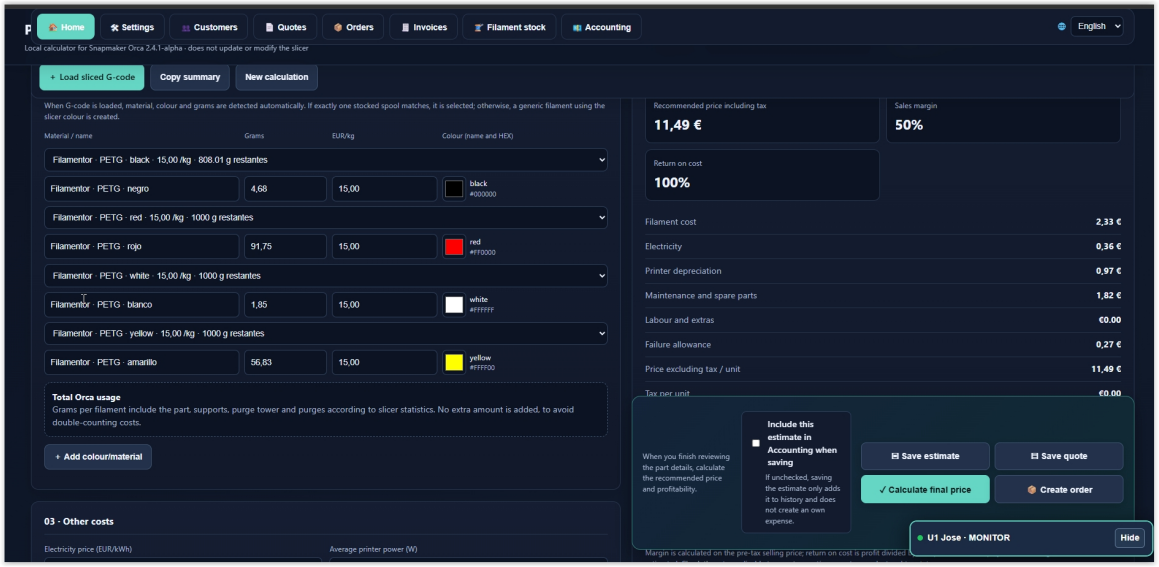
Quick start

1. Check printer profiles and cost settings. 2. Enter a print or import its G-code data. 3. Verify time, materials and colours. 4. Review cost, selling price and profit. 5. Save the valuation or create the relevant commercial document. 6. Link work to a customer/order and record income or expenses.

Important: automatic behaviour depends on correct configuration, printer compatibility and the data exposed by Orca, the G-code or the printer interface. Always review imported values and filament movements.

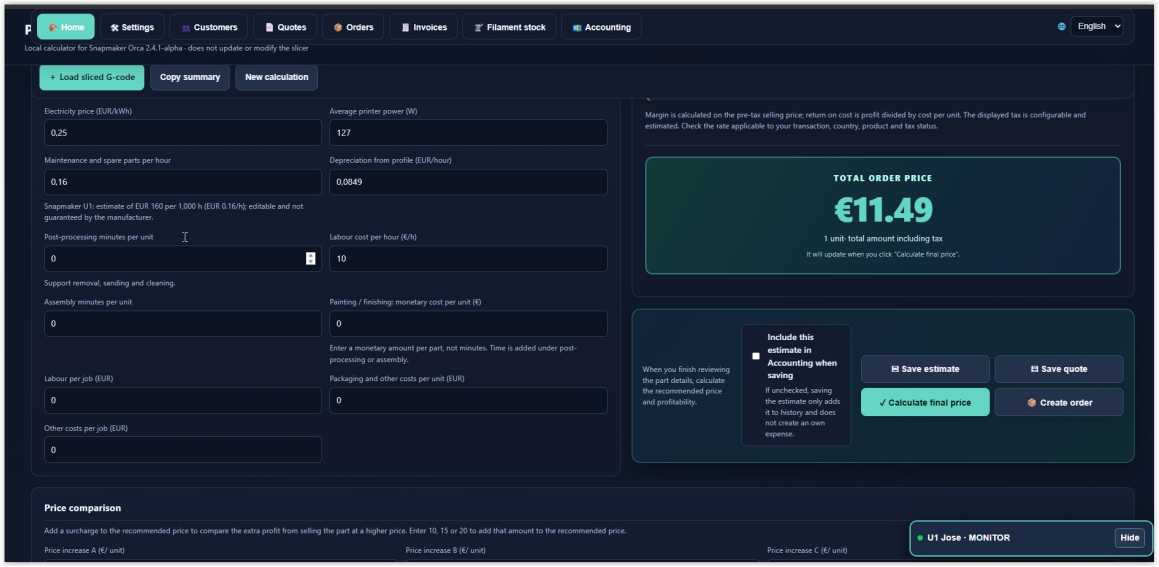
01. Cost calculator — inputs

The main calculation screen brings print parameters and filament entries together. Enter or verify the job details, materials and machine settings before calculating.



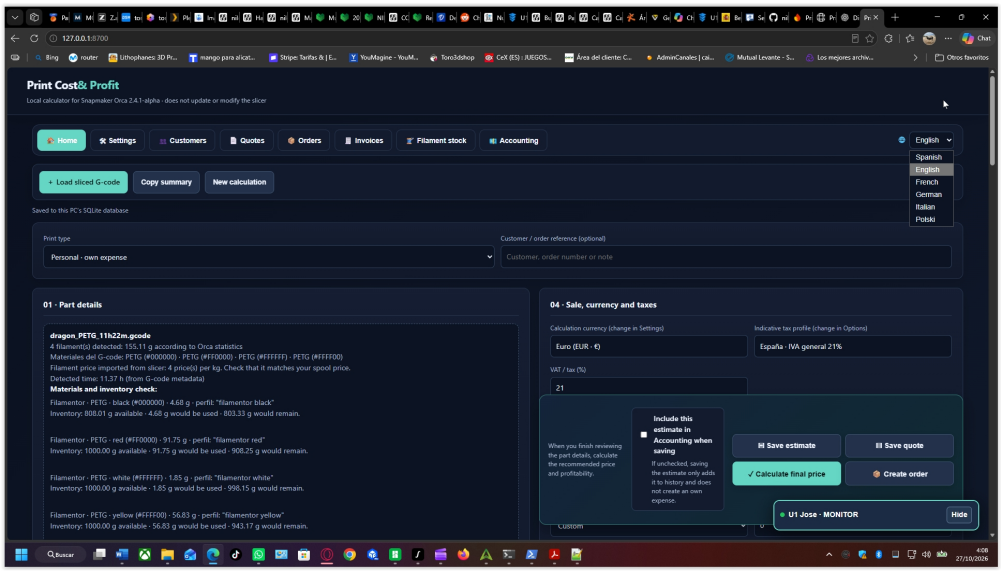
02. Cost calculator — result

The result view highlights the calculated amount and places the supporting cost figures nearby. Use this to assess the production cost and the proposed selling price before making an offer.



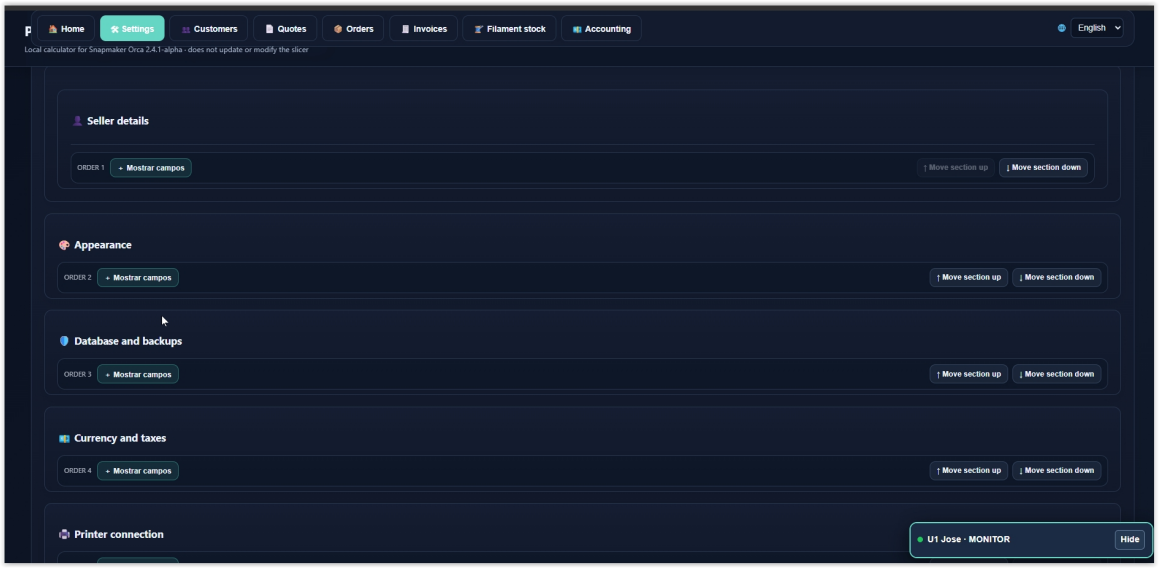
03. Orca / G-code workflow

The screenshot shows the calculator alongside a G-code workflow. When the integration is configured, saving a G-code in Orca can open the calculator with the job information that can be read from the file. Review the imported time and material figures.



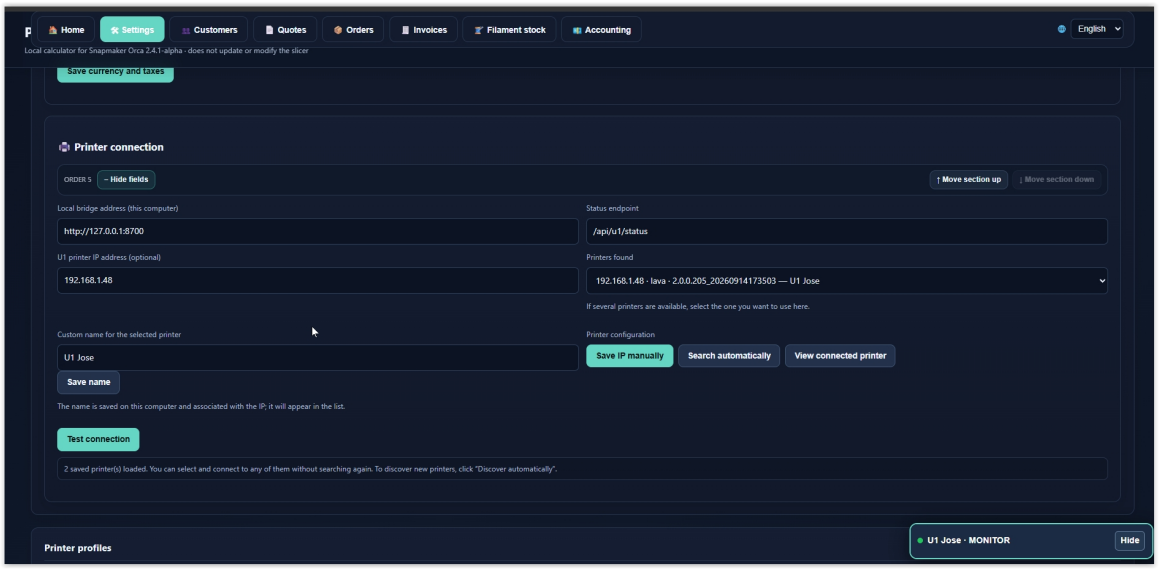
04. Saved records / list view

This screen is a list-style management view. Use the available controls to locate a record and open it for review; the precise fields depend on the selected section.



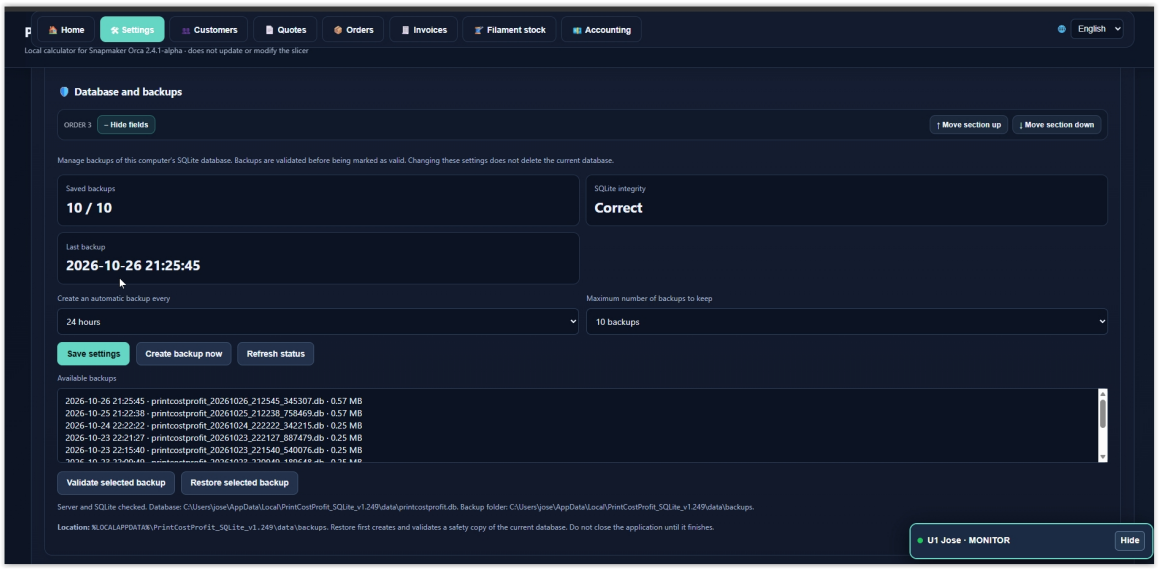
05. Record form

This form-style screen is for entering or editing the fields shown in the application. Complete the relevant information and save it so it can be reused in the workflow.



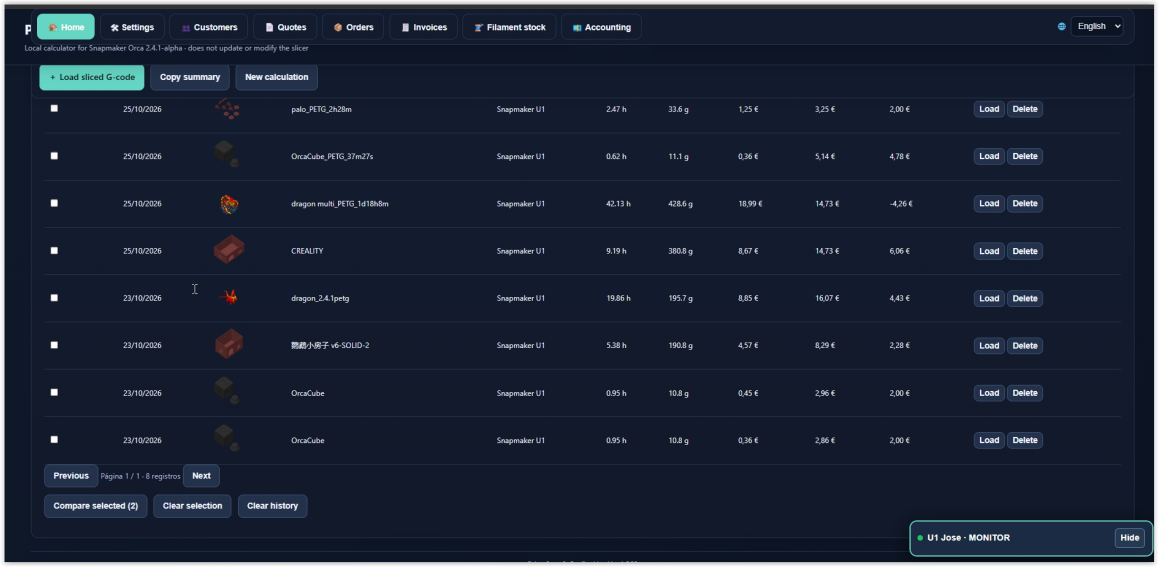
06. Record details and data

The screen includes structured record details and a text/data area. Check the displayed information before saving or using it in another part of the application.



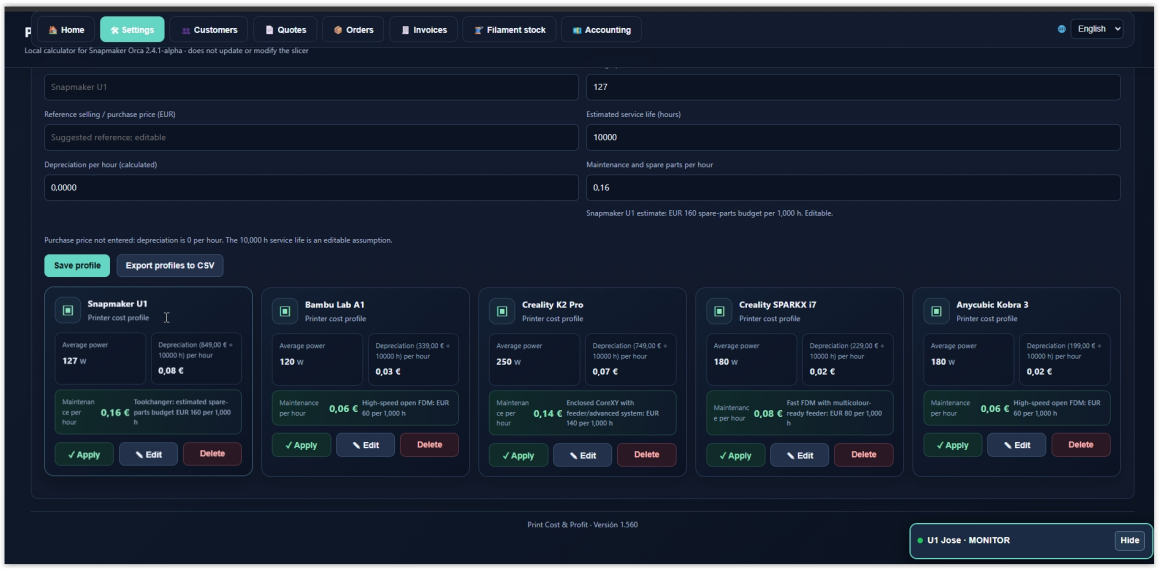
07. Filament / stock list

The table presents multiple filament or stock entries in rows. Use the list to compare entries and keep material and stock information organised.



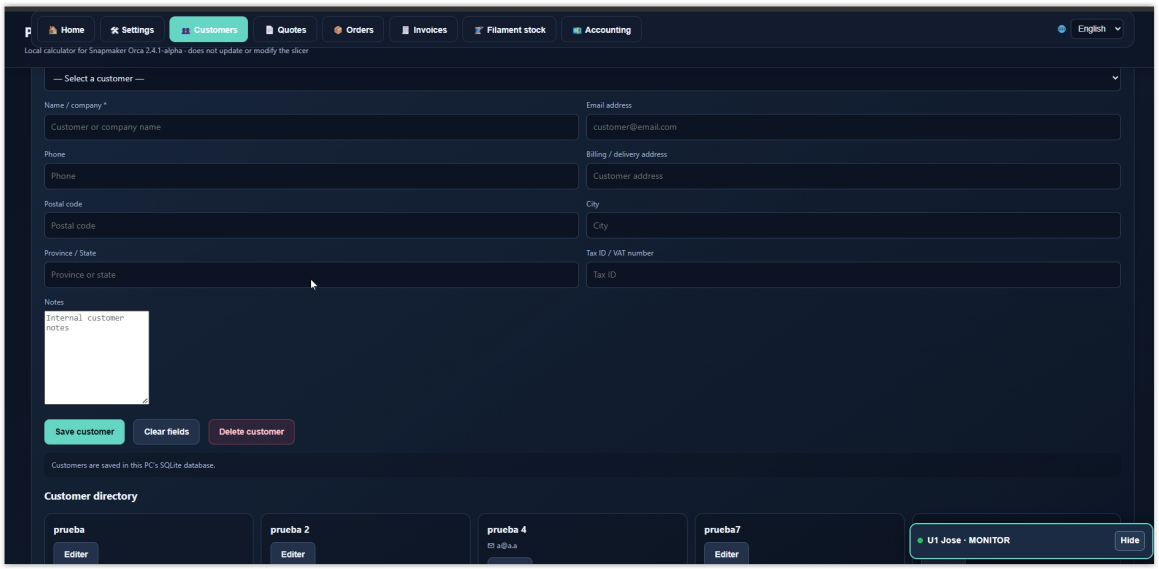
08. Printer profiles / cards

The cards provide a visual overview of multiple profiles or configured items. Select the relevant card for the printer or setup being used, and keep the profile values accurate.



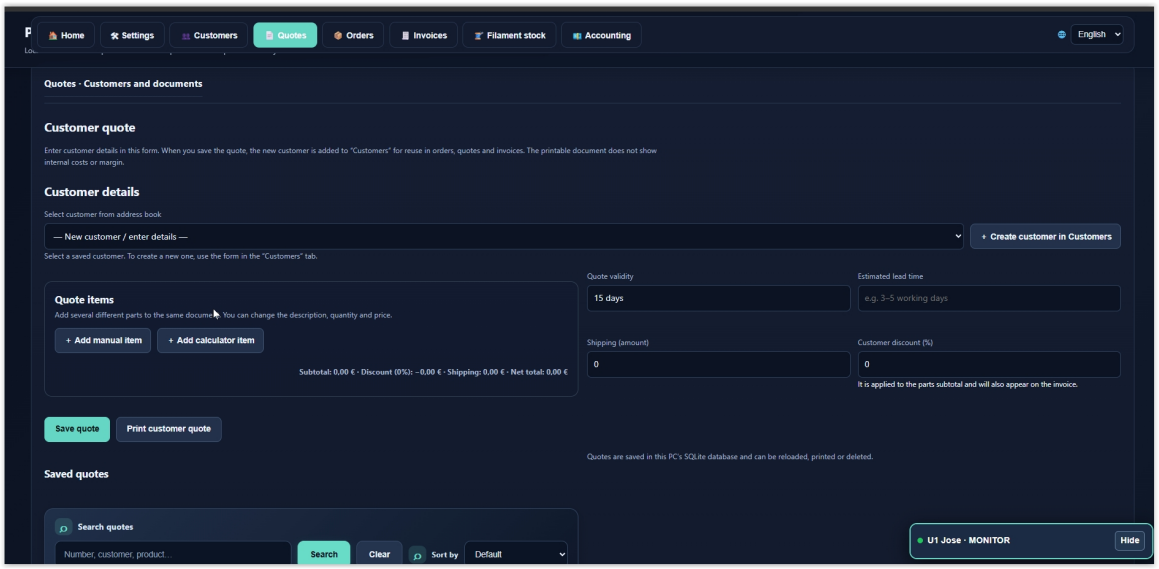
09. Edit details

This screen provides fields for editing a record, including a visible image/preview area. Review all entered values before saving changes.



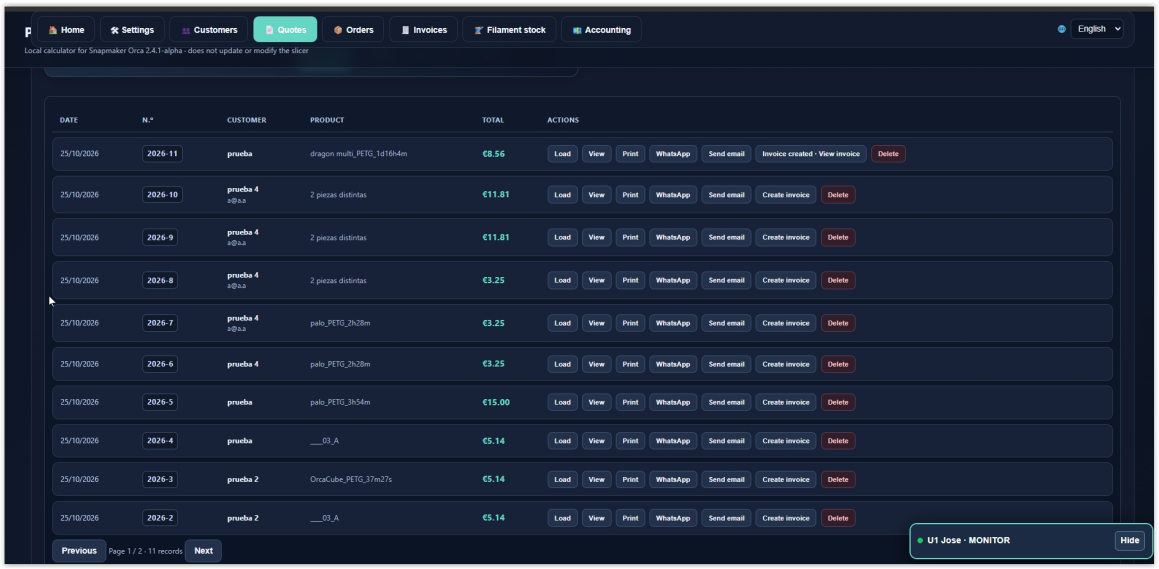
10. Configuration form

This configuration page groups related fields in one place. Set values according to your workflow and verify them before relying on the resulting calculations.



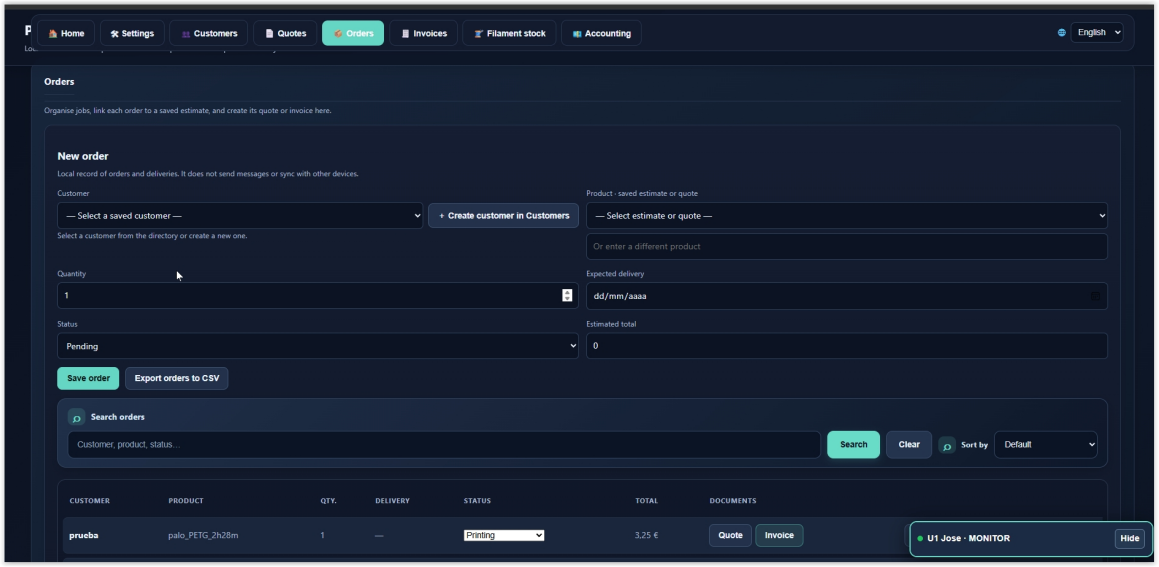
11. Records table

This table view is designed for reviewing several saved records at once. Use the visible columns and status indicators to find the item that needs attention.



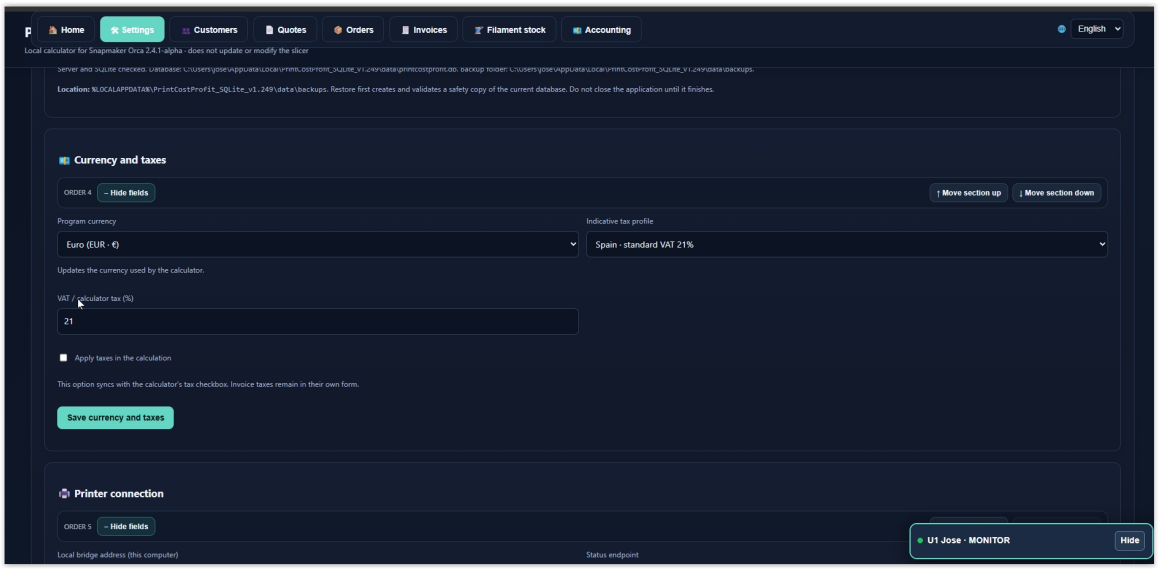
12. Settings / options

This screen contains settings and actions for the selected module. Change only the values you understand and preserve settings that are already working.



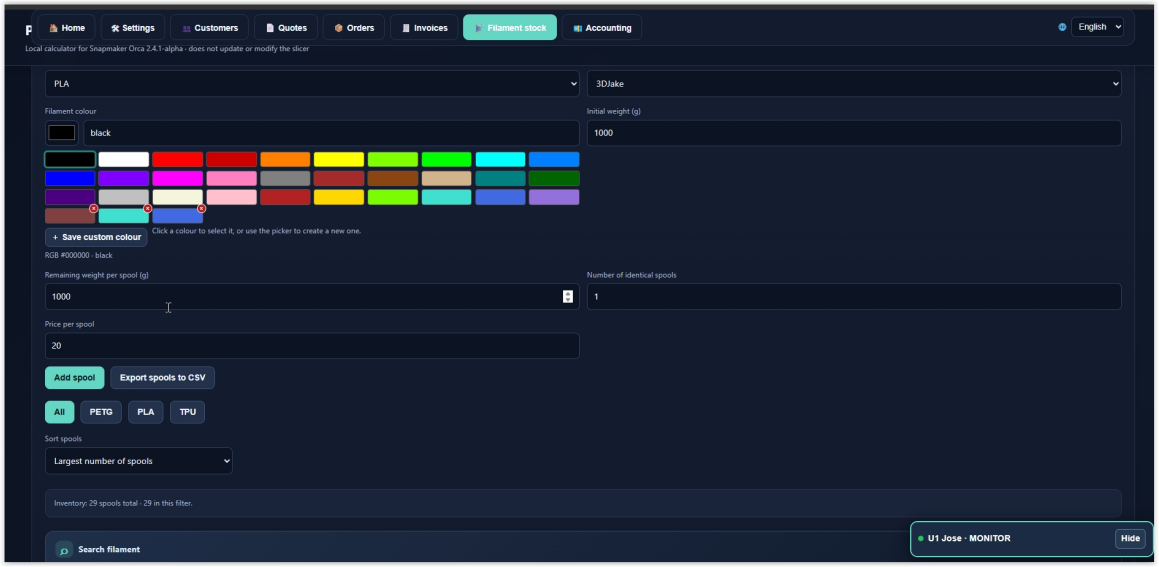
13. Profile or configuration detail

This page shows a detailed configuration form. It is useful for maintaining consistent parameters across repeated calculations or production tasks.



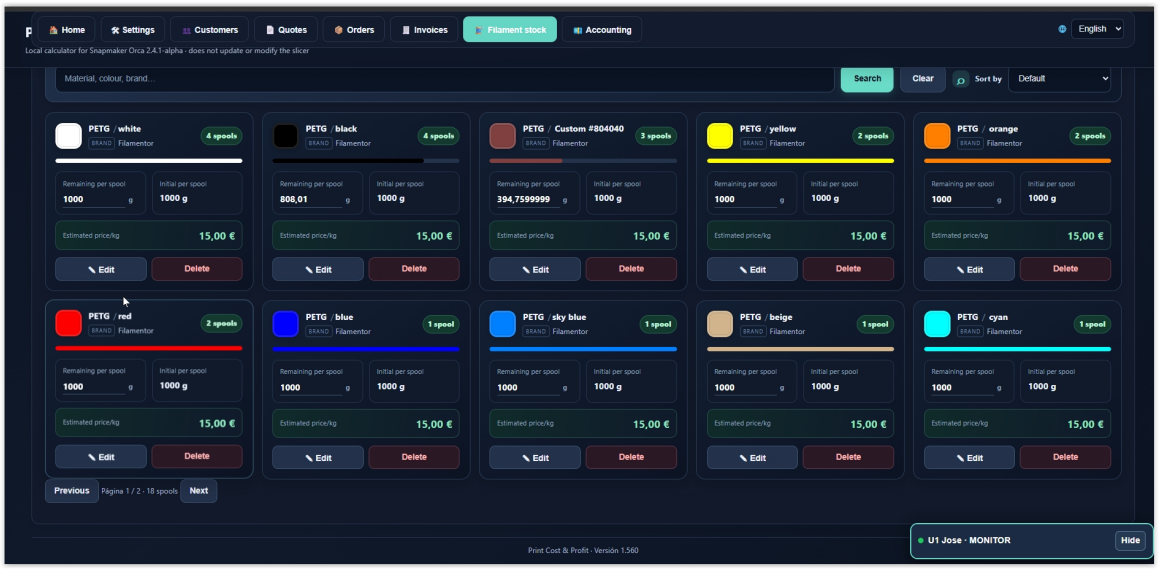
14. Multicolour setup

The colour strip makes the available filament colours visible together. For multicolour jobs, match each colour/material to the correct spool where the application provides that option.



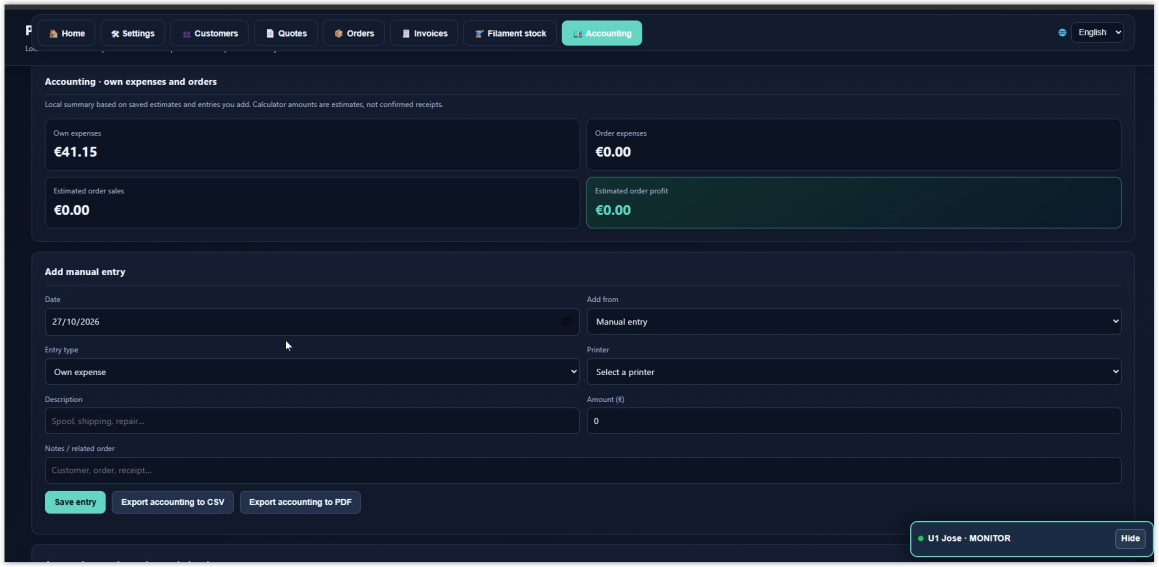
15. Filament inventory cards

The inventory cards make filament entries easy to scan visually. Keep material, colour, weight and price information current so stock and cost estimates remain useful.



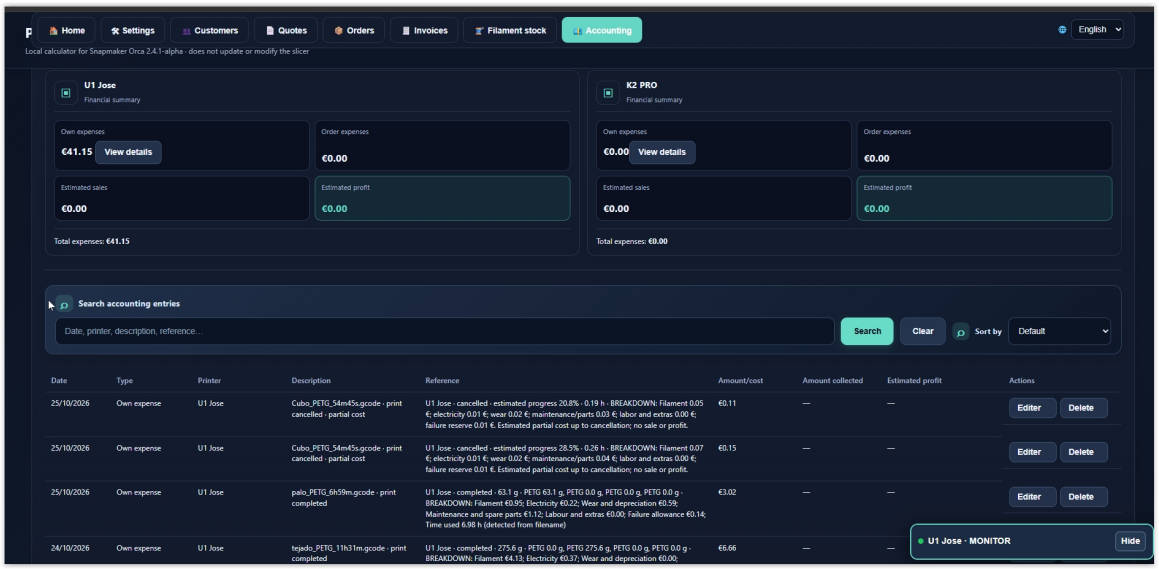
16. Financial or cost overview

This view groups monetary values for quick review. Use it to check the numbers and keep any manual sales or expense records up to date.



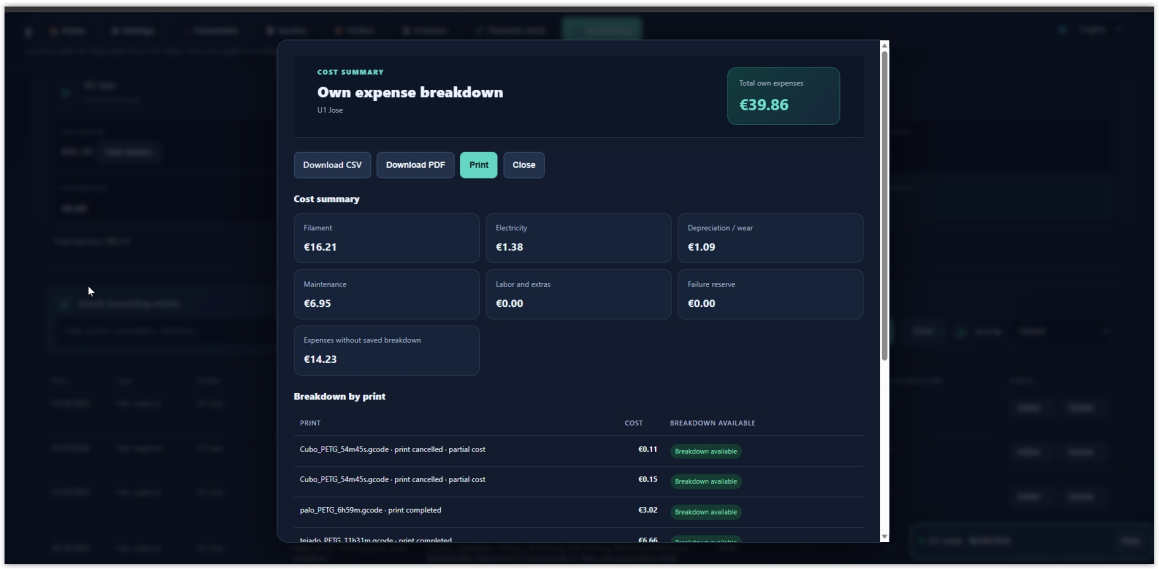
17. Valuation / quote form

This form is used to enter details for a saved valuation or commercial document. Save the calculation when you want to return to it later instead of starting over.



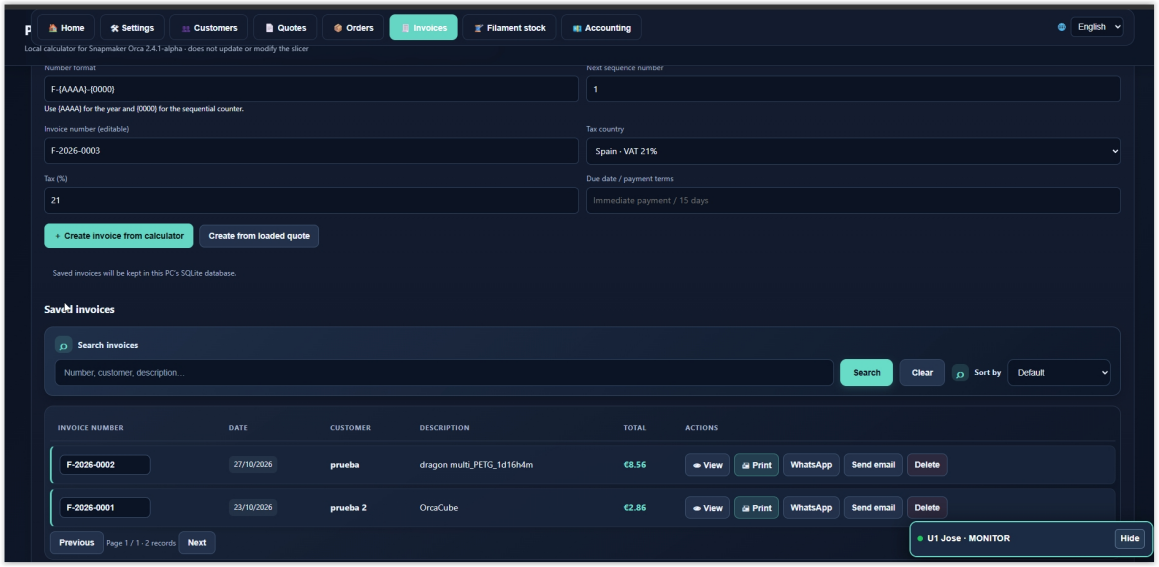
18. Record detail panel

The detail panel shows additional information for a selected record. Review its values and status before editing or using it as part of an order or accounting workflow.



19. Order / accounting table

This final table view supports reviewing multiple records and their current values or statuses. Use it as a working list and check entries before changing or sharing them.



20. Snapmaker U1 Monitor Panel

Live printer status, active G-code and filament assignment

Reading the monitor

The floating panel brings printer connection and current job information into one place. Values depend on the printer bridge and data available for the active G-code.



Key fields and actions

Connection / Status
Shows connection and the job state reported by the printer or bridge.

File / Progress / Layers
Identifies the active G-code and reports progress and layer counts when available.

Time / Reported filament usage
Displays reported print time and filament use; figures may be estimates.

Expected usage · active U1 G-code
Lists detected filaments, assigned spools and expected grams per filament.

Estimated total
Adds the listed expected material quantities. Confirm against the actual job.

Refresh
Requests an updated view of monitor data.

Record as personal expense / Record as order
Records the print in the relevant accounting workflow; review details before saving.

Close panel / Hide
Closes or collapses the floating monitor, depending on the control shown.

Note: estimated usage is not necessarily a live per-colour measurement. Inventory deductions depend on the configured workflow.